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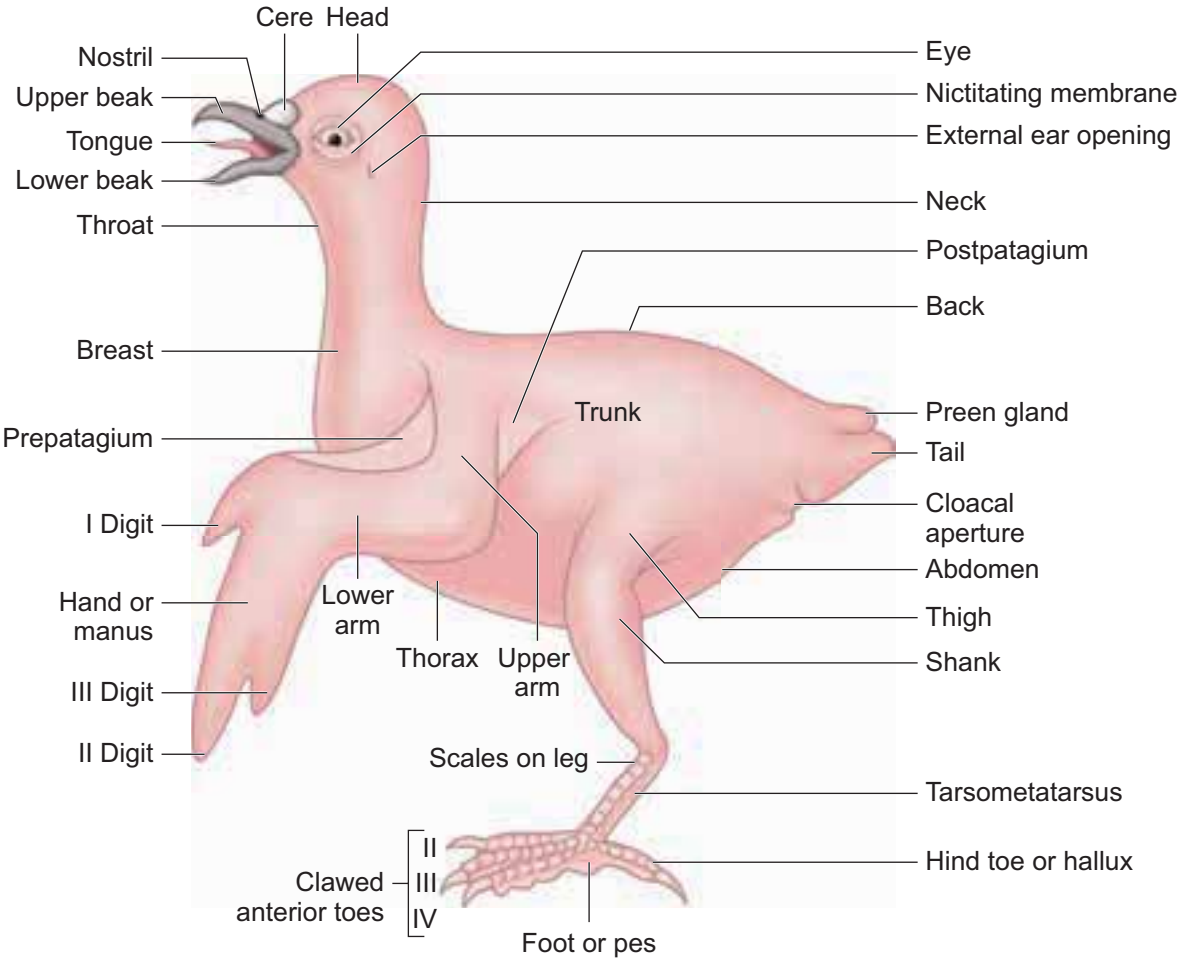


**Figure 4.27** Pigeon Defeathered bird in left lateral view

divisible into head, neck, trunk and tail. **Head** is comparatively small, spherical and situated at the anterior most part of the body. **Beaks** present anteriorly are formed by the elongation of upper and lower jaw and they are devoid of teeth. At the base of the beak are the **external nostrils** overhung by a swollen, sensitive soft skin called **cere**. **Eyes** are prominent, round and laterally present. Eyes are protected by an upper eyelid, lower eyelid, and a transparent **nictitating membrane**. Posterior to the eyes are the **ear** openings which lead to the **tympanic membrane** by a short tube, **external auditory meatus**. **Neck** is flexible, cylindrical and long which connects the head with the **trunk.** The spindle shaped trunk bears a pair of **wings** and a pair of **legs**. The **cloacal aperture** opens ventrally at the hind end of the trunk. Dorsally the base of the tail has a knob like papilla, which bears the opening of the **preen gland** or **uropygial gland**. It is the only cutaneous gland present and its oily secretion is used for lubricating or preening the feathers. The tail is used as a rudder in flight. **Fore limbs** are modified into wings. The wings have three typical regions, the upper arm (brachium), lower arm (ante-brachium) and the hand (manus). Three clawless and imperfectly marked digits are present on each hand. While at rest, each forelimb is folded in the form of **'Z'**; during flight they are extended. With the modification of the forelimbs for flight, the whole weight of the body is